Anderson broke it (100 off 36 balls) against the West Indies in January 2014.

There was some clarity the day I heard about Anderson breaking my Nairobi record. A year later, when I heard that AB de Villiers had broken Anderson's record – 100 not out off 31 balls, also against West Indies – the writing on the wall was stark and clear: my time was up. A new generation of players was at the helm. All that was left for me was a formal exit.

In retrospect, that's what the ICC 2015 World Cup and the World T20 in 2016 became for me: exit points. We live large lives; at least some of us do. But only some become larger than life. Not all of us get to pick when to say goodbye.

Take Sachin Tendulkar. He had, in my opinion, the perfect exit. He beat us fair and square in Mohali and then his team destroyed Sri Lanka to lift the World Cup in 2011, in his hometown, Mumbai. What a glorious career! What a perfect ending!

And then, there are the lesser mortals, who are edged out not by our choice, but by time and space.

This is a good moment to look back.

For someone who was brought into the team as a bowler, my batting became everything. Perhaps this was unfair, even unwise. The spectacle evolved. The fans proliferated. The crowds grew. The cameos unravelled. So did the frustrations and politics of the dressing room.

Then, a decade later, my bowling became essential. The quicker one. The googlies. The fast over rates. It's this very bowling that would peak in 2011, when I led Pakistan to the 2011 World Cup, got more scalps than anybody else but did not survive the death match versus India.

Yet, it was my batting that remained a question mark. It would make a mark in the shortest format indelibly. T20 would become my thing, but not for long. The World T20 in 2007 would be exciting but evasive. I would get Man of the Tournament, but not the crown. Still, in 2009, I would get a chance to stand and deliver: catching Scott Styris would change the tournament for us. It would change me. I was a different player against South Africa in the semis and against Sri Lanka in the final. But frankly, it had taken that horrific attack against the Lankans in Lahore and the death of international cricket in Pakistan to help me make sense of the whole thing, even myself.

I walked into trouble too – booting the pitch against England in 2005, eating the ball in Australia in 2010, taking on the PCB every few years and taking the coach head-on every few months. I was belligerent. I could have improved on that front, too.

But every time I would be banned or kicked out, I'd bounce back. Harder. Faster. Bigger. But eventually, I would stop getting better. There would be moments – like the 7 for 12 and the 76 against West Indies in 2013, and the Asia Cup in 2014. But by the time 2015 would roll around, I would be done. Almost done, till that will-we-or-will-we-not World T20 started in India in 2016.

What a disaster, eh? A proper one. Made in Pakistan, unfolded in India. The perfect storm.

Time for a brutal assessment. Bad decisions held us back in that tournament, my last one on the global stage. Bad selection held us back, too. For example, I wanted to drop a fast bowler and play Imad Wasim in the match against India at Kolkata. We needed a spinner. But Wiqi bhai and Intikhab Alam sahib wanted things their way.

I knew what could happen with all this lack of coordination and trust. Before that last trip to India, I had made a public disclaimer, which went viral and blazed through the press, that things weren't going to go well for us. I tried to play it down, and was serious about the need to get our